

University of San Diego
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Academic Employment

2025	University of San Diego Department of Philosophy Assistant Professor Center for Ethics, Economics, and Public Policy
2024	Duke University Center for the History of Political Economy Visiting Scholar
2022 – 2024	Chapman University Smith Institute for Political Economy and Philosophy Postdoctoral Research Associate

Education

2022	Ph.D., Philosophy, Duke University
2019	M.A., Economics, Duke University
2014	M.A., Philosophy, University College London
2013	B.Sc. Philosophy of Science, London School of Economics

Areas of Specialization	Philosophy of Science and Economics, Business Ethics, and Philosophy Politics and Economics (PPE)
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Areas of Competency	Political and Social Philosophy, Applied Ethics, and Philosophy of Biology
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Peer Reviewed Articles

Finestone, Kobi. Forthcoming. “The Ethics of Mergers and Acquisitions: Sharing the Epistemic Burden in Antitrust Regulation.” *Business Ethics Quarterly*.

Finestone, Kobi. 2026. “Why are Microfoundations Irrelevant? An Argument for Reorienting the Debate.” *Philosophy of the Social Sciences*. 56 (2): 177-194.

Finestone, Kobi. 2022. “Darwinian Rational Expectations”. *Journal of Economic Methodology*, 1-11. doi:10.1080/1350178X.2022.2035796

Finestone, Kobi and Ewan Kingston. 2021. “Crisis Prices: The Ethics of Market Controls during a Global Pandemic”. *Business Ethics Quarterly*, 1-29. doi:10.1017/beq.2021.15

Other Academic Publications

Kingston, Ewan and Kobi Finestone. Forthcoming. “How Bureaucratic Discretion Rescues Reserved Goods in a Crisis”. *The Business Ethics Journal Review*.

Finestone, Kobi. 2026. “Introduction”. *Journal of Economic Methodology*, 33 (1): 1-2. doi.0.1080/1350178X.2026.2639967

Under Review

Finestone, Kobi. “Opening Up the Model: Decomposition, Alteration, and the Prospects for Explanation.”

Finestone, Kobi. “Price Indexes and Administrative Legitimacy”.

In Progress

Finestone, Kobi. "Knightian Rational Expectations? Robert Lucas's Place at Chicago."

Finestone, Kobi. “Democracy, Work, and the Civil Servant Problem”

Jauernig, Johanna and Kobi Finestone. “Regulating Crisis Prices: Folk Economic Restrictions on Practical Permissivism.”

Amit Ron and Kobi Finestone. “Reasonable Budgeting.”

Peer Reviewed Talks

July 2026	Society for Business Ethics (Philadelphia), “Democracy, Work, and the Civil Servant Problem.”
May 2026	Business Ethics in the 6ix (Toronto, Canada), “Workplace Democracy and the Civil Servant Problem.”
March 2026	Western Political Science Association (San Diego, CA) “Reasonable Budgeting” – with Amit Ron.
January 2026	Allied Social Science Association Annual Meeting (Philadelphia, PA) “How Robert Lucas saw Frank Knight: Business Cycles, Rational Expectations, and the Phenomenon of Uncertainty.”

November 2025	Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA) “Workplace Democracy and the Civil Servant Problem”
November 2025	Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA) “What is PPE? An Integrated Approach with Uncertain Boundaries”
November 2025	Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA) “Fairness and Folk Beliefs: Investigating the Temporal Dimension of Crisis Prices.” – With Johanna Jauernig.
October 2025	Markets and Society (Falls Church, VA) “Workplace Democracy and the Civil Servant Problem.”
June 2025	History of Economics Society Conference (University of Richmond) “How Robert Lucas saw Frank Knight: Business Cycles and Rational Expectations.”
May 2025	Scientific Understanding and Representation Workshop (University of Miami) “Models Can Decompose that Way: Towards the Alteration Strategy.”
April 2025	American Philosophical Association Pacific Conference (San Francisco) “What is PPE? An Integrated Approach with Uncertain Boundaries.” – PPE Society Affiliated Session
March 2025	Philosophy of Social Science Roundtable (Emory University). “Why are Microfoundations Irrelevant?”
October 2024	Zicklin Center Workshops in Normative Business Ethics Schedule (University of Pennsylvania). Between Competition and Compliance: The Ethics of Mergers and Acquisitions.”
August 2024	Society for Business Ethics (Chicago). “Between Competition and Compliance: The Ethics of Mergers and Acquisitions.”
April 2024	BGSU Applied Ethics and Public Policy Workshop (Bowling Green State University). “Inflation, Interests, and the Public Good.”
March 2024	Philosophy of Social Science Roundtable (University of Texas at Dallas). “Inflation, Interests, and the Public Good.”
March 2024	Economic Methodology: Models, Measurement, and Interventions (Stanford University). “Inflation, Interests, and the Public Good.”
November 2023	Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Society Annual Meeting (New Orleans). “The Ethics of Mergers and Acquisitions.”
November 2023	Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Society Annual Meeting (New Orleans). “Eliminativism and the End of Economics.”
May 2023	International Network for Economic Methodology (Ca’Foscari University of Venice). “Economic Measurement within the Administrative State: An Accessibility and Accountability Account.”
September 2021	International Network for Economic Methodology (Arizona State University). “The Propensity Interpretation of Rational Expectations.”
September 2019	Soul of Economics Conference (University of Zurich). “Situated Expertise and Democratic Governance.”

August 2019	International Network for Economic Methodology (University of Helsinki). “The Incompatibility of Rational Expectations and Knightian Uncertainty: A Limit of Economic Knowledge.”
August 2017	International Network for Economic Methodology (San Sebastian). “Mind the Inference Gap: The Necessity of a Dynamic Solution.”

Peer Reviewed Panels

July 2025	PPE Society London Conference: “New Frontiers in PPE Pedagogy” with Vaughn Bryan Baltzly and Johanna Jauernig.
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Invited Talks

April 2026	UC San Diego Political Theory Workshop: “Workplace Democracy and the Civil Servant Problem.”
October 2023	Purdue University Department of Philosophy Colloquium Series: “Model’s Can Decompose That Way: An Alteration Account of Idealized Models.”
October 2023	Georgetown University McDonough School of Business Speaker Series. “The Ethics of Mergers and Acquisitions: It’s Not Business as Usual.”
May 2019	The Consortium for the History and Philosophy of Biology (Université de Paris). “Replaying the Ticker Tape: Contingency and the Efficient Market Hypothesis.”

Invited Comments

June 2026	Interview with Richard Endörfer on “The Wrongness of Bank Contributions to Financial Crises” for Phinance – The Philosophy of Finance Network.
February 2026	The Future of Liberalism and New Directions in Classical Liberal Thought Workshop (Institute for Humane Studies)
May 2017	The Consortium for the History and Philosophy of Biology (Université de Montreal). Comments on Marga Vicedo’s “The ‘Disadapted’ Animal: Niko Tinbergen on Human Nature.”

Workshops

January 2026	The US Federal Debt, Deficit, and State Capacity (Liberty Fund)
August 2023	AI and the Future of Work (Institute for Humane Studies)
July 2021	Politics, Philosophy, and Economics Graduate Summer Workshop (Chapman University)

Fellowships and Grants

2026	Free Society Grant for Undergraduate Programming [Institute for Humane Studies]: \$14,600 – with Matt Zwolinski
2025-2026	Harpst Fellowship on Migration [University of San Diego]: \$1,000
2025	International Opportunity Grant [University of San Diego]: \$2,000

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

University of San Diego

Morality, Markets, and Government
Introduction to Philosophy
Morality and Justice
Philosophy of the Natural Sciences

Chapman University

Business and Professional Ethics
Political and Legal Philosophy

Duke University

Introduction to Philosophy
Introduction to Symbolic Logic
Philosophy of Science

Other Experience

2026-2027	Keck Fellowship Mentor (University of San Diego)
July 2026	McNair Fellow Ship Mentor (University of San Diego)
June 2026	PPEL Summer School Instructor (University of San Diego)
February 2026	SoCal PPE Colloquium Faculty Moderator (University of San Diego)
February 2026	IHS Graduate Paper Workshop “New Directions in Classical Liberal Thought” Faculty Advisor (University of San Diego)
2025-2026	Keck Fellowship Mentor (University of San Diego)
June 2025	PPEL Summer School Instructor (University of San Diego)
February 2025	PPE Colloquium Faculty Moderator (University of San Diego)
Spring 2022	Thomson Writing Studio Consultant (Duke University)
Fall 2021	Thomson Writing Studio Consultant (Duke University)

Departmental Services

2026-Ongoing	Humanities Representative – Academic Review Committee
2025-Ongoing	Department Representative – Undergraduate Curriculum Committee

2020-2022	President – Duke Philosophy Graduate Student Association
2018-2019	Department Representative – Duke Philosophy Graduate Student Association

Professional Services

2023-Present	Reviewer – Economics and Philosophy, Philosophy of Science, Journal of Economic Methodology, Erasmus Journal for Philosophy and Economics, Social Theory and Practice, Journal for General Philosophy of Science, Philosophy of the Social Sciences
2026	Book Proposal Reviewer – Bloomsbury Press
2024-2026	Guest Associate Editor – Journal of Economic Methodology

Professional Affiliations

American Philosophical Association – Member
International Network for Economic Methodology – Member
The Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Society – Member
Society for Business Ethics – Member